A SCRIPTURE STUDY · FOR MINISTERS AND RECIPIENTS

The Importance of Forgiveness

What the whole Bible says about the danger of unforgiveness and the command to forgive, starting with the one line of the Lord’s Prayer that Jesus stopped to explain.

Deliverance ministry collateral
For the body of Christ

Why a whole study on forgiveness?

Forgiveness is not one topic among many in Scripture. It is the reason Jesus came (“the forgiveness of sins”, Luke 24:47), and it is the one thing He requires us to pass on. When Jesus taught His disciples to pray, He gave them six requests. Then, as soon as the prayer ended, He went back to *one* of them and explained it. He did not expand on daily bread, temptation or the kingdom. He spoke only about forgiveness (Matthew 6:14–15).

In deliverance ministry we see why. Unforgiveness is one of the most common footholds an evil spirit holds on to (Ephesians 4:27). Bitterness gives the enemy an advantage (2 Corinthians 2:10–11) and hands a person over to “tormentors” (Matthew 18:34). As one experienced minister puts it, “certain spirits will not leave if there’s unforgiveness.” So forgiveness comes early in every session, right after we anchor the person in who God is and who they are in Christ.



Forgiveness clears the ground. Renouncing and commanding then remove what used it.

Where forgiveness sits in the ministry flow: step two, before repentance, renouncing and commanding.

What is in this study

1 The one petition Jesus underlined
The Lord's Prayer, Matthew 6:14–15, Mark 11:25 and Luke 11:4

2 What Jesus taught about forgiving
The unforgiving servant, seventy times seven, the altar, loving enemies, the cross

3 The problems with unforgiveness
Twelve consequences, how bitterness grows, and Bible case studies

4 The call to forgive across Scripture
The Law, the Prophets, the Wisdom books, the apostles, and people who forgave

5 What forgiveness is, and what it is not
Forgiveness compared with trust and reconciliation

6 Forgiveness in a ministry session
Who to forgive, a guided prayer and commands, and notes for ministers

A Complete Scripture index
Every reference in this study, grouped by theme

THE HEART OF IT

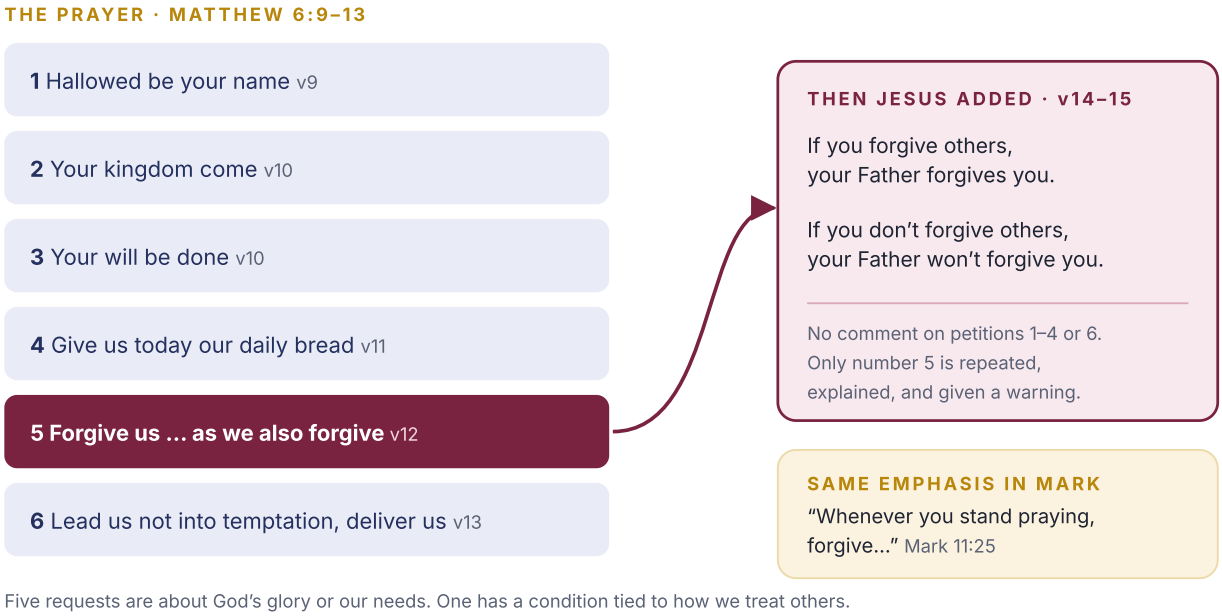
We forgive because we have been forgiven (Ephesians 4:32). Holding on to unforgiveness blocks our own forgiveness (Matthew 6:15), hinders our prayers (Mark 11:25) and gives the enemy a place (Ephesians 4:27). Letting go releases us and gives the debt to God, who judges rightly (Romans 12:19).

1 The one petition Jesus underlined

Matthew 6:9–15 · Mark 11:22–26 · Luke 11:1–4

The Lord's Prayer is the only prayer Jesus gave His disciples word for word. It holds six requests. The moment He finished it, Jesus added a two-verse comment, and that comment is about one request only.

> *"Forgive us our debts, as we also forgive our debtors." … "For if you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. But if you don't forgive men their trespasses, neither will your Father forgive your trespasses."*
>
> Matthew 6:12, 14–15



Five requests are about God's glory or our needs. One has a condition tied to how we treat others.

Of the six requests in the Lord's Prayer, forgiveness is the only one Jesus returned to and explained.

Four things that set this petition apart

1. **It is the only request with a condition.** Every other line asks God to act. This one asks God to forgive us *"as we also forgive"*, so we set the measure ourselves (compare Luke 6:38, "with the same measure you measure it will be measured back to you").
2. **It is the only request Jesus explained.** Right after "Amen", Jesus restated it in both a positive and a negative form (Matthew 6:14–15). Nothing else in the prayer received that attention.
3. **Luke makes it universal.** Luke's version reads, *"Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves also forgive everyone who is indebted to us"* (Luke 11:4). No one is left off the list.

4 **Jesus repeated it in a second prayer setting.** After teaching that faith can move mountains, He again tied answered prayer to forgiveness: *"Whenever you stand praying, forgive, if you have anything against anyone; so that your Father, who is in heaven, may also forgive you your transgressions"* (Mark 11:25).

A NOTE ON THE WORD "FORGIVE"

The Greek word in these verses is *aphiēmi*. Its basic meaning is to release, let go or send away. The same word is used for leaving nets behind (Matthew 4:20) and for cancelling a debt (Matthew 18:27). To forgive is to release a debt someone owes you and stop collecting on it.

Prayer and forgiveness are linked throughout Scripture

Matthew 6:12, 14–15 Our forgiveness is tied to forgiving others.

Mark 11:25 "Whenever you stand praying, forgive."

Mark 11:26 "If you do not forgive, neither will your Father..." (in many manuscripts)

Luke 11:4 "We ourselves also forgive everyone."

Matthew 5:23–24 Leave your gift at the altar and be reconciled first.

1 Timothy 2:8 Lift up holy hands "without anger and doubting."

1 Peter 3:7 Husbands honor wives "that your prayers may not be hindered."

Psalm 66:18 "If I cherished sin in my heart, the Lord wouldn't have listened."

Job 42:10 The LORD restored Job when he prayed for the friends who wronged him.

Matthew 5:44 "Pray for those who mistreat you."

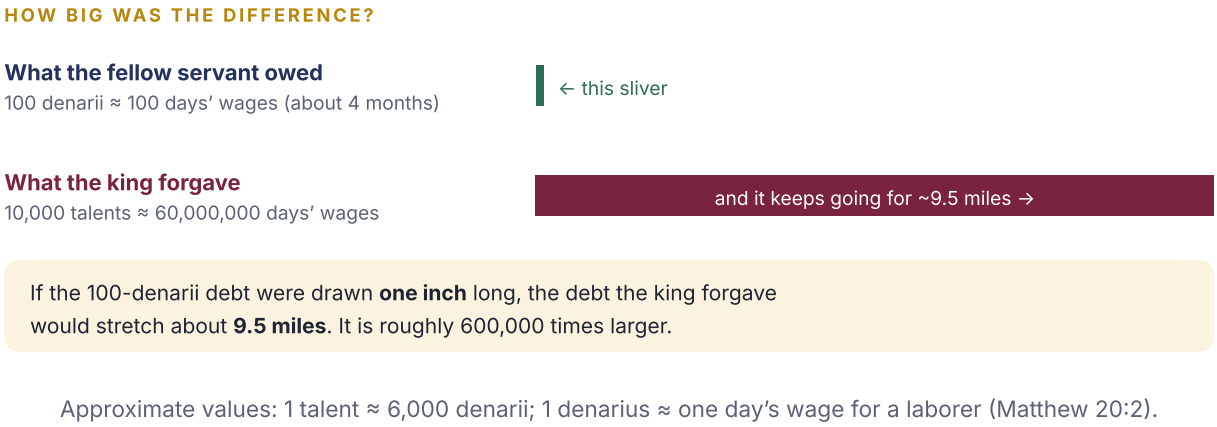
2 What Jesus taught about forgiving

Matthew 18 · Luke 17 · Matthew 5 · Luke 6 · Luke 23

The parable of the unforgiving servant (Matthew 18:21–35)

Peter asked how many times he should forgive a brother: “Until seven times?” Jesus answered, “I don’t tell you until seven times, but until seventy times seven” (vv. 21–22). In other words, stop counting. He then told a story to show why.

A servant owed the king ten thousand talents, a debt he could never repay. The king cancelled all of it. The same servant then found a fellow servant who owed him a hundred denarii, grabbed him by the throat and had him thrown into prison. When the king heard, he called the first servant back.



Approximate values: 1 talent ≈ 6,000 denarii; 1 denarius ≈ one day’s wage for a laborer (Matthew 20:2).

> *“‘You wicked servant! I forgave you all that debt, because you begged me. Shouldn’t you also have had mercy on your fellow servant, even as I had mercy on you?’ His lord was angry, and delivered him to the tormentors, until he should pay all that was due to him. So my heavenly Father will also do to you, if you don’t each forgive your brother from your hearts for his misdeeds.”*
>
> Matthew 18:32–35

WHAT THE PARABLE WARNS

- Unforgiveness is called **wicked** (v. 32).
- The unforgiving servant was handed to **tormentors** (v. 34). The Greek *basanistēs* means one who tortures or torments.
- Jesus applies it to us directly: “**So my heavenly Father will also do to you**” (v. 35).
- Forgiveness must be **from the heart**, not just words (v. 35).

WHAT THE PARABLE TEACHES

- Our debt to God is far larger than anything owed to us.
- Mercy received is meant to become mercy given (v. 33).
- There is no count to keep: “seventy times seven” (v. 22).
- Forgiveness cancels the debt. It does not wait for repayment (v. 27).

In deliverance ministry, “delivered to the tormentors” is often where we find people: harassed, unable to rest, stuck in cycles. We don’t claim every torment comes from unforgiveness, but Jesus named it as one clear doorway, so we always check it.

JESUS DID WHAT HE TAUGHT

Hanging on the cross, before any of His executioners had repented, Jesus prayed, *“Father, forgive them, for they don’t know what they are doing”* (Luke 23:34). He forgave first. Stephen followed His example as he was stoned: *“Lord, don’t hold this sin against them!”* (Acts 7:60).

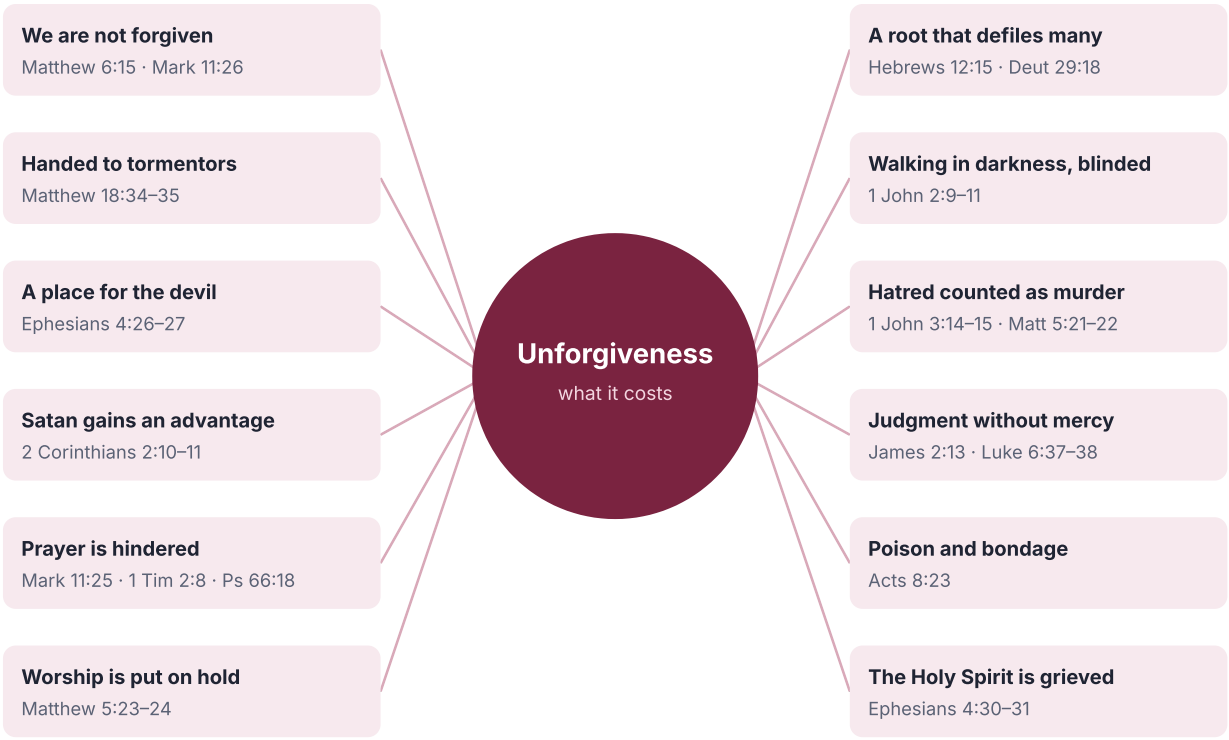
More of Jesus’ teaching on forgiveness

PASSAGE	WHAT JESUS SAID
Luke 17:3–4	“If your brother sins against you, rebuke him. If he repents, forgive him. If he sins against you seven times in the day, and seven times returns, saying, ‘I repent,’ you shall forgive him.”
Matthew 5:23–24	If you remember at the altar that your brother has something against you, leave your gift and “first be reconciled to your brother, and then come and offer your gift.” Worship waits for reconciliation.
Matthew 5:21–22	Anger toward a brother, and contempt (“Raca”, “You fool!”), puts a person in danger of judgment, just as murder does.
Matthew 5:38–48	Don’t repay evil for evil. “Love your enemies, bless those who curse you, do good to those who hate you, and pray for those who mistreat you.” This is how we show we are children of the Father.
Luke 6:27–38	“Don’t judge, and you won’t be judged. Don’t condemn, and you won’t be condemned. Set free, and you will be set free” (v. 37). “With the same measure you measure it will be measured back to you” (v. 38).
Matthew 7:1–5	Don’t judge. Take the log out of your own eye before the speck in your brother’s.
Matthew 18:15–17	When a brother sins against you, go to him privately first. The aim is to “gain your brother.”
Luke 7:36–50	The woman who was forgiven much loved much. “To whom little is forgiven, the same loves little” (v. 47).
Luke 15:11–32	The father runs to forgive the prodigal son. The elder brother’s resentment keeps him outside the celebration.
John 20:23	Jesus gives His disciples authority to release sins in the Holy Spirit.
Luke 24:47	“Repentance and remission of sins should be preached in his name to all the nations.”

3 The problems with unforgiveness

What Scripture says happens when we hold on

Scripture does not treat unforgiveness as a private feeling that only affects the person who holds it. It names concrete results: in our standing with God, in our prayers, in our relationships, and in the spiritual realm.



Twelve consequences of unforgiveness, each named in Scripture.

The key texts in full

> *"Be angry, and don't sin. Don't let the sun go down on your wrath, and don't give place to the devil."*
>
> Ephesians 4:26–27

> *"But to whom you forgive anything, I also forgive. … that no advantage may be gained over us by Satan, for we are not ignorant of his schemes."*
>
> 2 Corinthians 2:10–11

> *"Follow after peace with all men, and the sanctification without which no man will see the Lord, looking carefully lest there be any man who falls short of the grace of God, lest any root of bitterness springing up trouble you, and many be defiled by it."*
>
> Hebrews 12:14–15

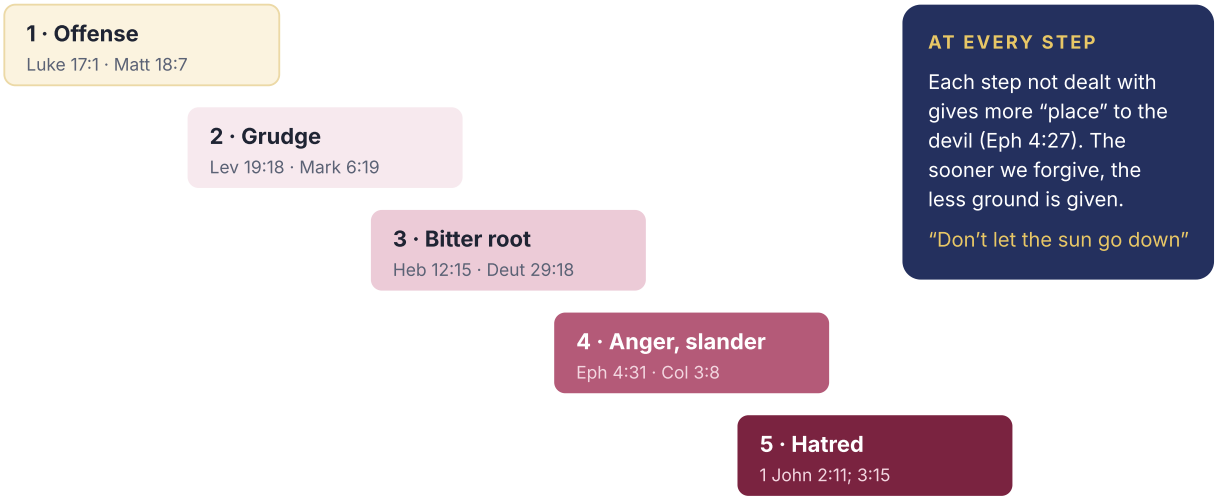
> *“But he who hates his brother is in the darkness, and walks in the darkness, and doesn’t know where he is going, because the darkness has blinded his eyes.”*
>
> 1 John 2:11

> *“For I see that you are in the poison of bitterness and in the bondage of iniquity.”*
>
> Acts 8:23, Peter to Simon the sorcerer

> *“For judgment is without mercy to him who has shown no mercy. Mercy triumphs over judgment.”*
>
> James 2:13

How bitterness grows

Hebrews 12:15 calls bitterness a *root*. A root is hidden, it grows over time, and it eventually produces fruit that others can see. Ephesians 4:31 lists the fruit in order: “bitterness, wrath, anger, outcry, and slander … with all malice.” Putting these passages together, Scripture traces a path like this:



A teaching summary drawn from the verses shown. Forgiving early stops the descent.

Bible case studies: where unforgiveness led

PERSON	WHAT THEY HELD ON TO	WHERE IT LED	REFERENCE
Cain	Resentment when God accepted Abel’s offering	God warned that sin was crouching at the door; Cain murdered his brother	Genesis 4:5–8
Esau	A grudge over the stolen blessing	Planned to kill Jacob (he later forgave him, Genesis 33:4)	Genesis 27:41

Joseph's brothers	Jealousy and hatred	Sold their brother into slavery	Genesis 37:4, 8, 11, 28
King Saul	Jealous anger toward David	"From that day" he eyed David; the next day an evil spirit came on him, and he tried to kill David	1 Samuel 18:8–11
Absalom	Two years of silent hatred toward Amnon	Murder, exile, then rebellion against his father	2 Samuel 13:22–29; 15
Haman	Offense at one man who would not bow	"All this avails me nothing"; he died on his own gallows	Esther 3:5–6; 5:9–13; 7:10
Herodias	"Held it against" John the Baptist	Engineered his execution	Mark 6:19–28
Jonah	Resentment that God forgave Nineveh	Anger so deep he wanted to die	Jonah 4:1–3, 9
The elder brother	Resentment at his father's mercy	Stayed outside the celebration	Luke 15:28–30
The unforgiving servant	A small debt after a huge one was forgiven	Handed to the tormentors	Matthew 18:28–34
Simon the sorcerer	A bitter, unrepentant heart	"In the poison of bitterness and the bondage of iniquity"	Acts 8:18–23

BODY AND SOUL

Scripture links the state of the heart with the body: "The life of the body is a heart at peace, but envy rots the bones" (Proverbs 14:30; see also 17:22 and Psalm 32:3–4). Forgiveness often brings real relief, and some people find physical symptoms ease. We don't promise that. If healing comes, a doctor confirms it before any medication changes, just as Jesus sent the healed lepers to the priests to be checked (Luke 17:14).

4 The call to forgive across Scripture

Law · Wisdom · Prophets · Apostles

The command to forgive did not begin with the Sermon on the Mount, and it did not end with the Gospels. It runs from the Law of Moses through the letters of the apostles.

Why we forgive: because God forgave first

> *"And be kind to one another, tender hearted, forgiving each other, just as God also in Christ forgave you."*
>
> Ephesians 4:32

> *"Put on therefore … a heart of compassion, kindness, lowliness, humility, and perseverance; bearing with one another, and forgiving each other, if any man has a complaint against any; even as Christ forgave you, so you also do."*
>
> Colossians 3:12–13

Psalm 103:10–12 As far as the east is from the west, so far has He removed our transgressions.

Psalm 130:3–4 "If you kept a record of sins … who could stand? But there is forgiveness with you."

Isaiah 43:25 He blots out our transgressions and will not remember our sins.

Isaiah 1:18 "Though your sins are as scarlet, they shall be as white as snow."

Jeremiah 31:34 "I will forgive their iniquity, and I will remember their sin no more."

Micah 7:18–19 He doesn't retain His anger; He casts our sins into the depths of the sea.

Daniel 9:9 "To the Lord our God belong mercies and forgiveness."

Nehemiah 9:17 "You are a God ready to pardon, gracious and merciful."

Romans 5:8, 10 God reconciled us while we were still enemies.

Colossians 2:13–14 He forgave all our trespasses and cancelled the record of debt.

Hebrews 8:12; 10:17 "Their sins … I will remember no more."

1 John 1:9 If we confess, He is faithful and righteous to forgive and cleanse.

The Law and the Wisdom books

Leviticus 19:17–18 Don't hate your brother in your heart; don't take vengeance or bear a grudge.

Exodus 23:4–5 Help your enemy's stray ox or fallen donkey.

Deuteronomy 32:35 "Vengeance is mine, and recompense."

Proverbs 10:12 Hatred stirs up strife, but love covers all wrongs.

Proverbs 17:9 He who covers an offense promotes love.

Proverbs 19:11 It is a person's glory to overlook an offense.

Proverbs 20:22 Don't say "I will pay back evil." Wait for the LORD.

Proverbs 24:17–18 Don't rejoice when your enemy falls.

Proverbs 24:29 Don't say "I will do to him as he has done to me."

Proverbs 25:21–22 If your enemy is hungry, give him bread.

Proverbs 14:10 The heart knows its own bitterness.

Proverbs 26:24–26 Hatred hidden by deceit will be exposed.

The apostles

Romans 12:14 Bless those who persecute you; bless, and don't curse.

Romans 12:17–21 Repay no one evil for evil; leave room for God's wrath; overcome evil with good.

Romans 12:18 "As much as it is up to you, be at peace with all men."

Romans 14:10, 13 Don't judge your brother.

1 Corinthians 13:5 Love "doesn't take into account evil" (keeps no record of wrongs).

2 Corinthians 2:5–11 Forgive and comfort the offender, so Satan gains no advantage.

2 Corinthians 5:18–19 God gave us the ministry of reconciliation.

Galatians 5:15 If you bite and devour one another, you will be consumed.

Galatians 5:19–21 Hatred, strife, jealousy and outbursts of anger are works of the flesh.

Galatians 6:1 Restore one who is overtaken in a fault, gently.

Ephesians 4:26–27, 31–32 Deal with anger the same day; put bitterness away; forgive.

Colossians 3:8 Put away anger, wrath, malice, slander.

Colossians 3:13 Forgive as the Lord forgave you.

1 Thessalonians 5:15 See that no one returns evil for evil.

Hebrews 12:14–15 Pursue peace; watch for any root of bitterness.

James 1:19–20 Man's anger doesn't produce God's righteousness.

James 2:13 Judgment without mercy to the one who shows no mercy.

James 5:9 Don't grumble against one another, so you won't be judged.

1 Peter 2:21–23 When reviled, Christ didn't revile back; He entrusted Himself to the Judge.

1 Peter 3:8–9 Don't return insult for insult; bless, so you inherit a blessing.

1 Peter 4:8 Love covers a multitude of sins.

1 John 2:9–11; 3:14–15; 4:20–21 Whoever loves God must love his brother.

People who forgave

WHO	WHOM THEY FORGAVE	REFERENCE
Joseph	The brothers who sold him: "You meant evil against me, but God meant it for good."	Genesis 45:4–15; 50:15–21
Esau	Jacob, who cheated him: he ran, embraced him and wept	Genesis 33:4
Moses	Miriam, who spoke against him: he cried out for her healing	Numbers 12:1–13
David	Saul, who hunted him: twice he spared Saul's life	1 Samuel 24:10–12; 26:9–11

Job	The friends who accused him: he prayed for them, and then God restored him	Job 42:8–10
Hosea	His unfaithful wife: he bought her back	Hosea 3:1–3
The father	The prodigal son: he ran to meet him	Luke 15:20–24
Jesus	Those who crucified Him	Luke 23:34
Jesus	Peter, who denied Him three times	John 21:15–19
Stephen	The men stoning him	Acts 7:60
Paul	Those who deserted him at his trial: “May it not be held against them.”	2 Timothy 4:16

5 What forgiveness is, and what it is not

Clearing up the misunderstandings that keep people stuck

Many people refuse to forgive because they misunderstand what forgiveness asks of them. Especially for those who have been abused, it helps to be clear: forgiving someone does not say that what they did was acceptable.

FORGIVENESS IS

- **Obedience.** Jesus commands it (Mark 11:25; Colossians 3:13).
- **A decision**, made by the will, often before feelings follow.
- **Releasing a debt**: the person no longer owes you (Matthew 18:27).
- **Handing judgment to God**, who judges rightly (Romans 12:19; 1 Peter 2:23).
- **From the heart**, not only from the lips (Matthew 18:35).
- **Ongoing**, "seventy times seven" (Matthew 18:22), and often done in layers as the Lord shows deeper hurt.
- **Freedom for you.** You are no longer tethered to the person or the event.

FORGIVENESS IS NOT

- **Saying it was okay.** Sin is still sin; God still calls it wrong.
- **Excusing** or minimizing what happened.
- **Pretending** there is no wound. Forgiveness is a step toward healing it.
- **Forgetting.** You may remember; the debt is what is released.
- **Trusting again** right away. Trust is rebuilt over time.
- **Returning to abuse.** You can forgive and keep a safe boundary.
- **Waiting for an apology.** Jesus forgave before anyone repented (Luke 23:34).

Forgiveness and reconciliation are different

Forgiveness



- Takes **one** person: you
- Between you and God
- Can happen today
- Always required (Mark 11:25)

Reconciliation



- Takes **two** people
- Needs repentance (Luke 17:3)
- Trust is rebuilt over time
- "As much as it is up to you" (Rom 12:18)

You can always forgive. Reconciliation also depends on the other person, and on whether it is safe.

Common objections, answered from Scripture

"I CAN'T FORGIVE BECAUSE..."	WHAT SCRIPTURE SAYS
"What they did was too bad."	Our debt to God was far greater, and He forgave it all (Matthew 18:24–27). Forgiving does not declare their act acceptable. It hands the case to the Judge (Romans 12:19).
"They haven't said sorry."	Jesus and Stephen forgave people who had not repented (Luke 23:34; Acts 7:60). Mark 11:25 says to forgive "if you have anything against anyone."
"I don't feel like forgiving."	Forgiveness is a choice of obedience. Feelings often follow later as the Lord heals the wound (Psalm 147:3).
"They will just do it again."	Forgive, and set a wise boundary. Proverbs 22:3 says the prudent see danger and take refuge.
"If I forgive, they get away with it."	No one gets away with anything. "Vengeance belongs to me; I will repay, says the Lord" (Romans 12:19; Deuteronomy 32:35).
"I already forgave, but it still hurts."	Forgiveness often comes in layers. Forgive again for each new hurt the Holy Spirit shows you (Matthew 18:22).
"I can't forgive myself."	If God has forgiven you, agree with Him and receive it (1 John 1:9; Romans 8:1). Refusing to receive His forgiveness sets your judgment above His.
"I'm angry at God."	God has done no wrong (Deuteronomy 32:4), so there is nothing in Him to forgive. Bring Him your honest pain (Psalm 62:8), lay down the accusation, and ask Him to show you His heart. "Blessed is he who is not offended by me" (Matthew 11:6).

6 Forgiveness in a ministry session

For recipients preparing, and for ministers leading

Deliverance ministry is prayer *and* commands. We pray to the Father, and in Jesus' name we command evil spirits to leave (Luke 9:1; 10:19). Forgiveness comes first because it removes the legal ground a spirit might claim. Once the ground is gone, the command to leave has nothing to hold on to.

Who you may need to forgive

Ask the Holy Spirit, "Is there anyone I need to forgive?" and write down each name and what they did. This list is a starting point, including but not limited to:

- ☐ Father and mother
- ☐ Ancestors whose sins opened generational curses
- ☐ Brothers, sisters and other relatives
- ☐ Spouse or former spouse
- ☐ Children
- ☐ Those who abused or exploited you
- ☐ Those who rejected or abandoned you
- ☐ Pastors, church leaders or members who hurt you
- ☐ Teachers, coaches, bosses or co-workers
- ☐ Friends who betrayed you
- ☐ Those who lied about you or shamed you
- ☐ Government, institutions or groups
- ☐ Yourself (receive God's forgiveness)
- ☐ Lay down any accusation against God

The steps

1. **Name the person.** Say their name out loud.
2. **Name the specific hurt.** "For…" Be honest about what it did to you and how it made you feel.
3. **Choose to forgive from the heart.** Release them from the debt.
4. **Hand them to God.** Give Him the right to judge, and give up your right to repay.
5. **Repent** of your own bitterness, resentment, judgment and any vengeful words.
6. **Renounce** the ground you gave the enemy through unforgiveness.
7. **Command** any spirit that used that ground to leave, in Jesus' name.
8. **Bless** the person (Luke 6:28; 1 Peter 3:9), and ask the Holy Spirit to fill the place that was emptied.

PRAYER AND COMMANDS · REPEAT AFTER THE MINISTER

Repeat for each person. Pause after "for" to name the specific hurts.

*Father, thank You that You have forgiven me of so much through the blood of Jesus. In obedience to You, I choose to forgive **[name]** for **[what they did]**. I release them from this debt. They owe me nothing. I give up my right to repay them, and I give them to You, the righteous Judge.*

I repent of holding unforgiveness, bitterness, resentment and judgment against them. Please forgive me. I receive Your forgiveness now.

In the name of Jesus Christ, I renounce every place I gave the enemy through this unforgiveness. I take back that ground and give it to the Lord Jesus.

COMMAND CALMLY, IN JESUS' NAME

Every spirit of unforgiveness, bitterness, resentment, anger, hatred, revenge and torment, and any other spirit that came in through this ground: your legal right is gone. I command you to leave me now, in the name of Jesus Christ.

*Holy Spirit, fill every place that has been emptied with Your love, peace and joy. Father, I bless **[name]**. Pour out Your mercy on them as You have on me. In Jesus' name, amen.*

FOR MINISTERS

- [ ] Go through forgiveness before commanding spirits to leave. If a spirit won't go, come back and ask the Holy Spirit whether anyone has been missed.
- [ ] Expect layers. A person may forgive, then remember a deeper hurt. Forgive each layer as it comes.
- [ ] Let the person name specific hurts and the feelings they caused. General forgiveness ("I forgive everyone for everything") rarely reaches the heart.
- [ ] For abuse survivors, say clearly that forgiving does not mean returning to danger. Help them think through healthy boundaries.
- [ ] Don't rush. Forgiveness can bring tears, coughing, yawning or other release. That is normal.
- [ ] Encourage daily practice afterwards: "Don't let the sun go down on your wrath" (Ephesians 4:26).

KEEP WALKING IN FORGIVENESS

- [ ] Pray the Lord’s Prayer daily, and mean the fifth line (Matthew 6:12).
- [ ] Settle offenses the same day (Ephesians 4:26).
- [ ] Pray a blessing over anyone who hurts you (Luke 6:28; Romans 12:14).
- [ ] When an old hurt resurfaces, forgive that layer too (Matthew 18:22).
- [ ] Remember how much you have been forgiven (Luke 7:47; Ephesians 4:32).

A Complete Scripture index

Every reference in this study, grouped by theme

THE LORD'S PRAYER AND PRAYER

Matthew 6:9–15 · Mark 11:22–26 · Luke 11:1–4 · Matthew 5:23–24 · Matthew 5:44 · Luke 6:28 · 1 Timothy 2:8 · 1 Peter 3:7 · Psalm 66:18 · Job 42:8–10

JESUS' COMMANDS AND TEACHING

Matthew 5:21–22 · Matthew 5:38–48 · Matthew 6:14–15 · Matthew 7:1–5 · Matthew 11:6 · Matthew 18:15–17 · Matthew 18:21–35 · Mark 11:25–26 · Luke 6:27–38 · Luke 7:36–50 · Luke 15:11–32 · Luke 17:1–4 · Luke 23:34 · Luke 24:47 · John 20:23 · John 21:15–19

CONSEQUENCES OF UNFORGIVENESS

Matthew 6:15 · Matthew 18:34–35 · Mark 11:26 · Luke 6:37–38 · Ephesians 4:26–27 · Ephesians 4:30–31 · 2 Corinthians 2:10–11 · Hebrews 12:14–15 · Deuteronomy 29:18 · 1 John 2:9–11 · 1 John 3:14–15 · 1 John 4:20–21 · James 2:13 · James 5:9 · Acts 8:23 · Galatians 5:15 · Galatians 5:19–21 · Proverbs 14:10 · Proverbs 14:30 · Proverbs 17:22 · Proverbs 26:24–26 · Psalm 32:3–4

CASE STUDIES OF UNFORGIVENESS

Genesis 4:5–8 (Cain) · Genesis 27:41 (Esau) · Genesis 37:4–28 (Joseph's brothers) · 1 Samuel 18:8–11 (Saul) · 2 Samuel 13:22–29; 15 (Absalom) · Esther 3:5–6; 5:9–13; 7:10 (Haman) · Mark 6:19–28 (Herodias) · Jonah 4:1–9 (Jonah) · Luke 15:28–30 (elder brother) · Matthew 18:28–34 (unforgiving servant) · Acts 8:18–23 (Simon)

GOD'S FORGIVENESS, THE REASON WE FORGIVE

Psalm 103:10–12 · Psalm 130:3–4 · Isaiah 1:18 · Isaiah 43:25 · Jeremiah 31:34 · Micah 7:18–19 · Daniel 9:9 · Nehemiah 9:17 · Romans 5:8–10 · Romans 8:1 · Colossians 2:13–14 · Hebrews 8:12 · Hebrews 10:17 · 1 John 1:9 · Ephesians 4:32 · Colossians 3:13

THE COMMAND TO FORGIVE, LOVE AND NOT AVENGE

Leviticus 19:17–18 · Exodus 23:4–5 · Deuteronomy 32:35 · Proverbs 10:12 · Proverbs 17:9 · Proverbs 19:11 · Proverbs 20:22 · Proverbs 24:17–18 · Proverbs 24:29 · Proverbs 25:21–22 · Romans 12:14–21 · Romans 14:10, 13 · 1 Corinthians 13:5 · 2 Corinthians 2:5–11 · 2 Corinthians 5:18–19 · Galatians 6:1 · Colossians 3:8, 12–13 · 1 Thessalonians 5:15 · James 1:19–20 · 1 Peter 2:21–23 · 1 Peter 3:8–9 · 1 Peter 4:8

PEOPLE WHO FORGAVE

Genesis 33:4 (Esau) · Genesis 45:4–15; 50:15–21 (Joseph) · Numbers 12:1–13 (Moses) · 1 Samuel 24:10–12; 26:9–11 (David) · Job 42:8–10 (Job) · Hosea 3:1–3 (Hosea) · Luke 15:20–24 (the father) · Luke 23:34 (Jesus) · John 21:15–19 (Jesus and Peter) · Acts 7:60 (Stephen) · 2 Timothy 4:16 (Paul)

HEALING, BOUNDARIES AND AUTHORITY

Psalm 147:3 · Psalm 62:8 · Proverbs 22:3 · Deuteronomy 32:4 · Luke 9:1 · Luke 10:19 · Luke 17:14 · Matthew 4:20 · Matthew 20:2

Notes. Scripture quotations are based on the World English Bible (public domain); compare with your preferred translation. Mark 11:26 does not appear in some of the oldest manuscripts, so many modern Bibles place it in a footnote; its message is the same as Matthew 6:15, which is in every manuscript. The bitterness staircase is a teaching summary that combines the passages cited, not a sequence given in one verse. The "certain spirits will not leave" quotation is from Brian Bomar's "Prep for Deliverance" teaching.